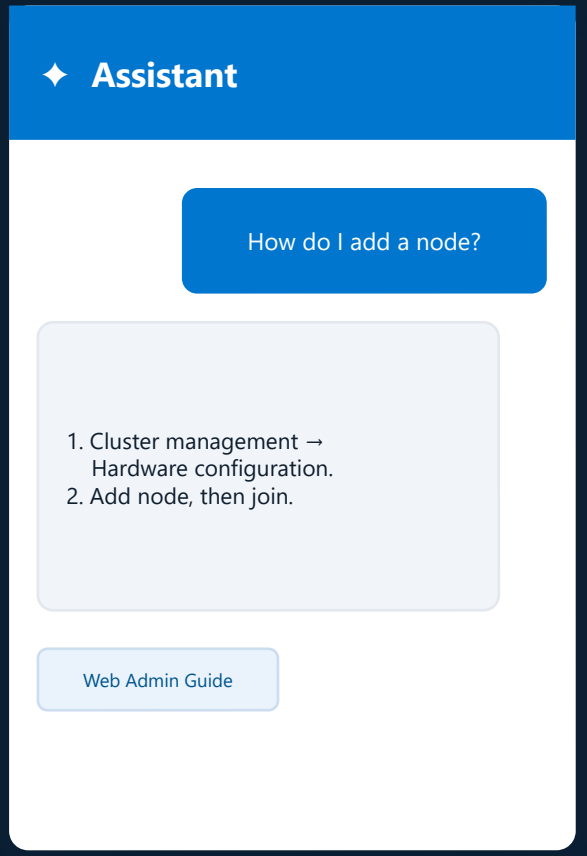
CONCEPT PROPOSAL · DELL POWERSCALE

PowerScale Assistant

An expert OneFS administrator, embedded in the console.



Runs 100% local · grounded in official OneFS 9.12 documentation · nothing leaves the cluster

THE PROBLEM

OneFS is powerful — but expert-gated

The knowledge to run it exists — it just isn't where the admin is working. So routine questions become tab-switches, guesswork, and Dell support cases.

Deep, dense product

11 official manuals, thousands of pages. Answers exist — buried.

Out of the workflow

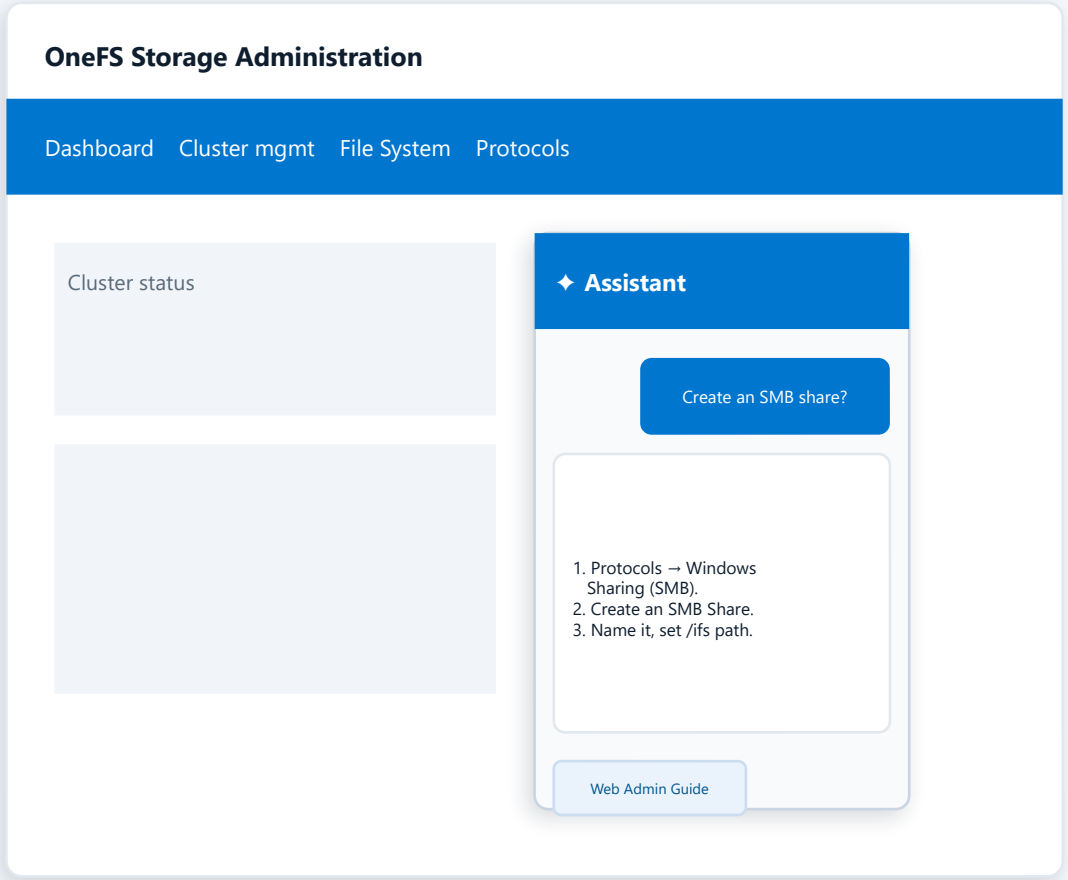
Help means leaving the console for a PDF, a KB portal, or a ticket.

Expert-gated

Junior admins stall on senior knowledge; mistakes drive support load.

THE CONCEPT — AND THE PROOF

Embedded, cited — and it already works, fully local



Ask in plain English, in the console. Answers come only from official OneFS docs, with citations — and it says "I don't know" rather than guess.

- ✓ Grounded in official documentation
- ✓ Cites its sources on every answer
- ✓ Says "I don't know" — no hallucination

11
official manuals indexed

5,205
passages searchable

0.73–0.79
retrieval relevance

0
answers leave the box

HOW IT SHIPS & GROWS

Ships as a sidecar; grows read-only-first

On-cluster

Low–Med

Smallest footprint, but inference competes with storage I/O.

Sidecar appliance

Recommended

A small VM beside the cluster — off the nodes, air-gap-safe.

CloudIQ / APEX AIOps

Connected

Dell-hosted SaaS for customers who allow connectivity.

Then earn trust in phases:

0	1	2	3	4
Doc Q&A	**Live read-only**	**Guided actions**	**Cross-product**	**Proactive**
today	via Platform API	RBAC + audit	CloudIQ fleet	detect & predict

THE BET

Fewer tickets. Faster admins. A bet bigger than PowerScale.

Deflect support cases

Admins self-serve from the docs instead of opening Dell cases.

Lower the expertise barrier

Junior admins get senior-level guidance — expanding who can run OneFS.

A product feedback flywheel

Anonymized questions reveal doc gaps and unmet needs Dell can't see today.

One engine extends across the portfolio: *PowerStore · PowerEdge (Redfish) · PowerProtect · VxRail — CloudIQ as the hub.*

The ask: green-light a Phase 0–1 pilot on a sidecar with two design-partner clusters.